

Ethical Assessment
Law, Ethics, and Equity
Jim Pham
7/18/2006

While I was an instructor at Ohlone College, a student approached me to request a letter of recommendation for a job. My immediate response was "Sure, I am glad to help you." This student participated in every class meeting and always asked in-depth questions concerning the topic at hand. I was under the impression that she was always prepared for class by reading ahead and always scored well on quizzes. She also received an A for that class.

I asked her about the job she was applying for. What was the company? What was the job description? As I collected my thoughts before writing the letter, I questioned whether I should continue writing because I am neither her co-worker nor her direct supervisor. I don't know if her past professional experience would enable her to perform well in this job.

After careful consideration, I wrote a nice and cordial letter to the employer. I recommend her for that position based on the facts at hand. She was a good and resourceful student. She understood the subject that I taught well. In addition, I believe she is resourceful and good at finding solutions to problems.

Questions:

Do I have other options?

Was it ethical to write this letter without the background?

Please let me know what you think.